



Alexa Canady
1950–present

As the first African-American woman to become a neurosurgeon in the US, Alexa smashed down barriers in science and medicine. She became chief of neurosurgery at a children's hospital, helping hundreds of young patients.



Carlos Chagas
1879–1934

Brazilian doctor Carlos discovered the microscopic parasite that causes a deadly illness now known as Chagas disease. He showed how insects passed it from person to person. Importantly, he also described how tackling poverty could stop the disease from spreading.



Annie Easley
1933–2011

Annie began her career as a human computer at NASA. At first, she did complex calculations by hand. As technology changed, she became a brilliant computer scientist, writing programs that made new types of power technology possible.



Lloyd Noel Ferguson
1918–2011

As a biochemist, Lloyd researched the carbon-based molecules that make up all living things, revealing strange secrets behind our sense of taste. Lloyd was also a brilliant teacher, helping hundreds of Black students to get started in chemistry.



Robert Hooke
1635–1703

Robert made incredible discoveries in many areas of science, from the rotation of planets to the structure of snowflakes. He came up with the word “cell” and discovered Hooke's Law, which predicts how much a material will be stretched by a given force.



Muhammad ibn Zakariya al-Razi
854–925 CE

Many discoveries about the way our bodies work can be traced back to this genius Persian doctor. He wrote more than 220 books about medicine and chemistry, all while running a busy hospital!



Hans Krebs
1900–1981

Hans shared the 1953 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine for his discovery of an important series of chemical reactions that allow living things to release energy from their food. This process is known as the Krebs cycle.



Wangari Muta Maathai
1940–2011

Wangari was a biologist who founded the Green Belt Movement, which tries to stop deforestation. It led to more than 30 million trees being planted. Wangari became Kenya's first female professor and the first African woman to win a Nobel Prize.